

# Tersa.ai vs Refly-like App - Detailed Comparison

This report compares Tersa.ai (visual AI workflow builder with broad model integrations) and our Refly-like app (agentic research-to-content workspace with RAG, citations, editor, and journeys).

## Positioning

| Aspect         | Tersa.ai                                                                    | Refly-like App                                                           |
|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Primary Focus  | Visual node-based workflows across many AI models (text/image/video/speech) | Research → knowledge → writing pipeline with citations, editor, journeys |
| Customization  | High, via graph composition and many providers                              | High, via LangGraph journeys and modular services; opinionated UX        |
| Learning Curve | Moderate-high for complex graphs                                            | Low-moderate for content teams                                           |

## Capabilities

| Area               | Tersa.ai                                      | Refly-like App                                                           |
|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Models/Providers   | Broad coverage (hundreds of models/providers) | OpenRouter-backed; extensible, fewer prewired providers today            |
| Canvas             | Drag/drop nodes, connect and run workflows    | Mind map/outline generator, nodes+edges, knowledge panel, save/templates |
| Multimedia         | Text, images, video, speech pipelines         | Text-first; multimedia planned                                           |
| Knowledge & Search | Depends on node set-up; flexible              | File/URL ingest, embeddings, semantic search, citations                  |
| Editor             | External or node-based generation             | Built-in AI assists, citations, MD/HTML export (blocks planned)          |
| Orchestration      | Graph execution within the canvas             | LangGraph journeys (research/summarize/write)                            |
| Workspaces/Auth    | Varies by deployment                          | Workspaces with planned RBAC                                             |
| Observability      | Varies                                        | Logging; LangSmith integration planned                                   |

## Pros & Cons

|                | Pros                                                               | Cons                                                                            |
|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Tersa.ai       | Broad model support; visual builder; multimedia pipelines          | Graph complexity; resource heavy for large flows; content UX not specialized    |
| Refly-like App | Content-centric canvas, RAG + citations, editor, threads, journeys | Fewer provider integrations; multimedia pending; advanced editor/collab pending |

## Use Cases

| Category             | Tersa.ai                                                                            | Refly-like App                                                                          |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Research & Writing   | Assemble research pipelines with search/summarize nodes; export to external editors | Ingest sources, semantic search, citations, AI drafting within built-in editor          |
| Technical Docs       | Use code analysis and generation nodes; integrate LLMs for explanations             | Knowledge-backed drafting, code/diagram generation (Mermaid planned), exports           |
| Data/ML Pipelines    | Chain models (embedding, re-rankers), image/video/speech nodes in one graph         | Focus on RAG and journeys (search→summarize→write); ext. ML orchestration via LangGraph |
| Marketing Content    | Create multimedia campaigns; generate assets (text, images, video)                  | Audience research via knowledge, structured briefs, AI writing, citations               |
| Legal/Compliance     | Compose checklists/flows; plug in OCR/transcription for evidence handling           | Clause extraction (via journeys), tracked citations, structured document templates      |
| Customer Support     | Speech-to-text, summarization, response generation pipelines                        | KB-backed responses, summaries, and artifacted reports                                  |
| Education & Training | Assemble lesson generators with multimedia outputs                                  | Syllabus outlines, knowledge-backed lessons, handouts with citations                    |
| Product/Engineering  | Code transformation, doc generation, design-to-asset pipelines                      | RFCs/PRDs with knowledge context, diagrams, review workflows                            |

## Technology Comparison

| Layer         | Tersa.ai                         | Refly-like App                                                   |
|---------------|----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Frontend      | Visual node/graph builder UI     | Angular app: Chat, Canvas, Editor; SVG edges; workspace selector |
| Orchestration | Graph execution within platform  | LangGraph journeys for multi-step flows                          |
| LLM Access    | Many providers/models integrated | OpenRouter (chat + embeddings); extensible adapters              |
| Storage       | Varies by deployment             | Postgres + pgvector (semantic), MinIO (files)                    |
| Search/RAG    | Configurable via nodes           | Ingest (files/URLs), embeddings, semantic search, citations      |
| Observability | Platform-specific                | Server logs; planned LangSmith tracing                           |
| Collaboration | Platform-specific                | Planned Yjs CRDT for real-time canvas/editor                     |
| Deployment    | Open-source; depends on repo     | Docker Compose, K8s (planned), env hardening                     |

## Enterprise Guidelines

| Domain                    | Guidelines                                                                                                                                                        |
|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Security & Compliance     | Enforce SSO/OIDC, MFA; ensure data encryption in transit/at rest; maintain audit trails; align to SOC 2/ISO 27001; implement DLP and secret scanning.             |
| Data Governance           | Classify data (PII/PHI/PCI); define retention and deletion; enforce data residency; support data subject requests (GDPR/CCPA).                                    |
| Model & Provider Controls | Maintain allowlists; capture model/version in traces; validate eval results; support provider failover; track cost per request and per team.                      |
| Prompt & Content Safety   | Use prompt templates with guardrails; enable toxicity/safety filters; implement redaction for sensitive fields; log prompts/outputs for QA with PII minimization. |
| RBAC & Tenancy            | Enforce workspace isolation; role-based access (admin/editor/viewer); resource scoping for canvases, docs, datasets; periodic access reviews.                     |
| Observability             | Trace all runs (inputs/outputs, tokens, latency); integrate with LangSmith or equivalent; export metrics to APM; define SLOs for latency and error rates.         |
| Deployment & SRE          | Use IaC; isolate services by blast radius; blue/green or canary deploys; autoscaling; rate limiting; WAF; regular security patching.                              |

|                      |                                                                                                                                                  |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Change Management    | Require PR reviews; maintain versioned prompts/flows; run regression tests (golden sets); keep a rollback plan; document runbooks.               |
| Resilience & DR      | Back up vector DB and metadata; multi-AZ where applicable; DR drills; provider failover plans; graceful degradation for noncritical features.    |
| Cost & FinOps        | Budgets/alerts per workspace; daily cost reports; cache/grounding to reduce tokens; batch background jobs; pick cost-optimized models per task.  |
| Testing & Evaluation | Maintain eval suites (quality, safety); offline A/B for model changes; automatic drift detection; human-in-the-loop review for critical outputs. |

## Recommendations

- Use **Tersa.ai** for general AI workflow IDE needs, especially multimedia and diverse model combos.
- Use the **Refly-like app** for research-to-document pipelines with knowledge retrieval and citations.
- Hybrid: expose Tersa nodes as steps in LangGraph journeys to combine breadth with content UX.

Note: Details are based on publicly available information and our current implementation status; confirm specific enterprise requirements during evaluation.